

it's difficult to use the conventional keyboard. It could also have been a lot better if all the keys had a depression in the centre, similar to the home and search keys, so that the stylus could be used for pressing the keys. The keys are too slippery to press with the stylus, and too small for convenient typing. It just ends as a waste of precious real estate.

It's best to get used to entering data using the Graffiti area because of the ability to define your own abbreviations for long words, such as 'br' for breakfast. You will need to get used to the Graffiti area, with the help of the character set provided by Sony.

To play songs, or see short movies, or for backup, an external memory stick is needed, because of the memory constraint of the CLIE. Another disadvantage of using the CLIE for multimedia is the rapid battery consumption.

For connectivity with

Price: Rs 27,000
Contact: Solar Systems
Phone: 022-5691 6834
Fax: 022-2854 9184
E-mail: solarsystems@vsnl.net
Web site: www.sonymstyle.com

Mercury Desknote A-907

Carry the book and the desk together

Kobian has released the Desknote, an intermediate between notebooks and desktop PCs. It is a black and silver notebook that features a 14.1-inch XGA TFT screen, with a maximum resolution of 1,024 x 768 with 16 million colours. It uses a low-power Transmeta Crusoe TM5600 at a frequency of 533 MHz with a front side bus of 66 MHz. A 20 GB hard disk



other devices, the device comes with IR and Bluetooth capabilities. There is also a game—*Reversi*—that can be played with another compatible Bluetooth device.

This feature-rich, hi-tech, device costs a few thousands extra as compared to some other PDAs, but is less than the cost of similar PDAs that have Bluetooth capability. Its performance is excellent, but the absence of a cradle for the stylus is a problem. Apart from that, the wide range of accessories makes it a gadget you'll certainly love to have!

SPECIFICATIONS

200 MHz processor, 16 MB ROM, 16 MB RAM, Palm OS 5, Bluetooth and IR capable, high-resolution 320 x 320 TFT display with backlights, integrated keyboard with backlight, USB interface, Li-Ion rechargeable battery, built-in voice recorder and MP3 player.

Sony CLIE PEG-TG50		A-
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	

with Windows 98 SE. It also has a low-end Mitsumi 24X CD-ROM.

Hotkeys are provided for increasing and decreasing the volume, launching the e-mail client and a some other miscellaneous functions. The keypad area is big enough for you to rest your palm.

Desknote runs only on continuous power supply from the AC mains—no battery is

provided. The lack of a battery reduces the overall weight of the Desknote to 2.2 Kg, with a dimension of 320 x 265 x 39 mm.

Desknote is meant as a space-saving replacement for a desktop PC. It's priced too high, compared to a second hand laptop that would offer a better configuration and much more portability.

Price: Rs 47,000, plus taxes
Contact: Mega Infosolutions
Phone: 022-24083903
Fax: 022-24091748
E-mail: rohan@meganet1.com
Web site: www.desknoteindia.com

Adobe Acrobat Professional 6

Added flavours, but will they be savoured?

Adobe Acrobat has grown from being a mere X-platform print format, to a complete workflow system. Adobe has finally split Acrobat Writer into three flavours—Acrobat Elements, Acrobat Standard and Acrobat Professional. These differ from each other in features and price. By far, Adobe Acrobat Professional is the most enhanced version with something for almost everyone.

Acrobat Professional brings along with it Flash support, improved prepress, collaboration, review and commenting features, improved JavaScript support and an in built debugger for JavaScript. Users in the multimedia segment can now integrate Flash movies within PDF files. The layers remain intact within the PDF, when converting Photoshop images to PDF files. It takes a toll on the hard disk space, but file sizes can be kept under control by using the Reduce File Size and PDF

Price: Rs 23,500 (Upgrade - Rs 7,400); Standard - Rs 15,600 (Upgrade - Rs 4,900)
Contact: Adobe Systems India
Phone: 0008006501152 (Toll Free)
Fax: 0120 - 2537681
E-mail: sandeepm@adobe.com
Web site: www.asia.adobe.com

SPECIFICATIONS

14.1-inch XGA TFT screen, Transmeta Crusoe TM5600 processor at 533 MHz, 128 MB SD RAM, Sis 300/305 Rev 90—16 MB shared, 24X CD-ROM, 2.2 Kgs, 4 USB ports, serial port, parallel port, VGA display port, RJ-11 modem jack, RJ-45 Ethernet jack, IrDA port, line in, 1 video TV-out port, Windows 98 SE bundled.

Mercury Desknote A-907		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	



Optimizer features. It has loads of features built into it, but the question is, how many users will ever need these features, and be willing to pay for them?

End users would be better off with some cheaper third party PDF creators.

Large organisations, might find the workflow solutions bundled along with the PDF creator a good deal.

SPECIFICATIONS

Pentium-class processor, Windows NT Workstation 4.0 with SP6\2000 Professional with SP2\XP, Internet Explorer 5.01, 64 MB RAM, 245 MB of available hard-disk space, 1,024 x 768 screen resolution

Adobe Acrobat Professional 6		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	